



TALKING CRYPTO 1. Aabha Bakaya, Senior Editor & Presenter, *Business Today* TV, with Kashif Raza, Founder, Bitinning; Co-founder & CEO, RARIO 2. Sourav Majumdar with Neeraj Khandelwal, Co-founder, CoinDCX; and Sumit Gupta, CEO & Co-Trade Solutions; Nikhil Chinapa, Co-founder, OxdotTV; and Deepak Bagla, MD & CEO, Invest India 4. Siddharth Zarabi with Court, and Founder, Cyber Saathi 5. Aabha Bakaya with Jagdish Mitra, Chief Growth & Strategy Officer, Tech Mahindra; N.S. Rajan, Shri Vishwakarma Skill University 6. Aayush Ailawadi with L. Badri Narayanan, Executive Partner, Laxmikumaran & Sridharan;

was how cryptos and blockchain have developed a decentralised mechanism of incentivising people into forming communities. At the same time, much more can be done.

The stage was then set for a heart-to-heart 'exchange' with Sumit Gupta, CEO and Co-founder, and Neeraj Khandelwal, Co-founder of CoinDCX, a crypto exchange. The session saw the duo shield some tough questions from *Business Today's* Editor Sourav Majumdar. They expressed concern that the provisions of the new crypto tax law, introduced in Budget 2022, could lead to trading activity moving away from home-grown exchanges. "Countries like Dubai and Thailand are in the process of becoming crypto hubs because of the positive regulations, and are attracting a lot of investments as

SOME PANELLISTS FELT INDIA IS MISSING OUT ON THE ECONOMIC BENEFITS OF THE CRYPTO INDUSTRY DUE TO THE GOVERNMENT'S CAUTIOUS APPROACH

well as talent. India should be able to harness this potential to build applications on blockchain technology if we have a favourable regulatory environment. Under the current tax provisions, the trading volumes are expected to dry up," said Gupta.

But then, where are the blockchain specialists going to come from? That was the peg of the next panel discussion on skilling for disruptive technologies. "Out of the 2 million-odd IT skilled professionals, only 5,000 are blockchain professionals," said Jagdish Mitra, Chief Growth & Strategy Officer, Tech Mahindra. "We have to build our own talent pool with the help of academia because there is no ready pool outside to dip into." The panelists were unanimous that creating awareness about the field and skill-